

ICSIM

Film Tourism Triangulation of Destinations

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Abstract

Marketing of destinations through films by product placement is a new phenomenon applied by DMOs since they have realized its economic impact on driving tourists to destinations by creating a desirable image visually and literally in films. In order to support film tourism that enhances the brand image of the destination, DMOs adapt many activities to attract filmmakers through various strategies. In this regard, film tourism is studied by many scholars but for the first time this research aims to center both qualitative and quantitative research in addition to the literature review. This study targets all the members of DMAI with their activities related to destination marketing before and after the release of films through a quantitative research. In addition each destination website was examined to find out how destinations benefit internet technology through a list of items in terms of destination marketing. The results provide fruitful implications both for scholars and practitioners.

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1. Introduction

Books regularly lead to new streams of tourists, and have been doing so for a long time (Reijnders, 2011). But when subject is a film, it is only possible to come ‘closer’ to the story once it is clear where the story takes place, and once the location has been ‘validated.’ (Reijnders, 2011). In fact, a deeper emotional connection between viewers and a TV drama is an important vehicle for the audiences to become film tourists (Kim, 2012). Prospective tourists are deemed to be drawn to destinations through the assimilation of images of places used as backgrounds and foregrounds in the (popular) media productions (Kim, 2012). The main implication is the product placement one - that its use as a film location has considerable value; consequently it is worthwhile taking steps to attract television film and movie companies, and making the best use of the exposure once secured (Tooke & Baker, 1996). Films are a passive involvement entertainment form, rarely employed as a promotional device primarily to enhance the awareness, appeal, and profitability of tourist destinations (Tooke & Baker, 1996). A movie may generate and sustain interest in a destination in a way which destination marketers cannot afford to do (Tooke & Baker, 1996).

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The exposure a film gives a city, province or country is an advertisement viewed by 72 million people, the average worldwide screen audience for a movie (Tooke & Baker, 1996). A TV programme or a motion picture in a prime destination not only brings in money to the location during the actual filming, which could be quite significant, it can also inspire people to visit the location for years afterwards (Kima et. al, 2007). Many fans may become familiar with a destination by participating in various activities related to the celebrity (Lee et al. 2008). Thus, this study focuses on studying film tourism and destination-marketing organizations related activities from a perspective that combines both quantitative and qualitative research on the same subject.

2. Film Tourism Promotion Through DMOs

Recognition gained from motion picture films can be substantial and the recouped value through increased tourism, when compared with paid advertising promotions, is worthwhile (Riley & Van Doren, 1992). If a film has uniqueness, status or timely significance it will magnify the tourism potential of a destination (Riley & Van Doren, 1992). In the same study of Riley & Van Doren (1992) it's been mentioned that motion picture films do adhere to the definition of 'hallmark events' because they are of limited duration in viewing time and in the number of days at cinematic venues. On the other hand, unlike movies, TV series provide weekly reinforcements of a destination's appeal and local tourism boosters state that top-of-mind awareness can do wonders for tourism (Kima et. al, 2007). For the purpose of attracting tourism, the creative placement of a tourist destination can be achieved by having onscreen characters with whom viewers can develop strong parasocial relationships, exhibit positive attitudes toward the location (Su et al. 2011). For instance, celebrities are cultural icons that can act as a proxy for shaping the perceptions and needs of many audience members in a postmodern society (Lee et al. 2008). On the other hand cultural proximity plays a key role in determining the strength of the effects. To make product placement (TV-induced tourism) a more effective strategy, it is important for a country to promote its cultural symbols or heritage internationally (Su et al. 2011). Furthermore, destination managers should develop and commoditise souvenirs containing emotional meaning and nostalgic values embedded in viewers' viewing experiences (Kim, 2012).

3. Triangulation

Methodological triangulation: involves using more than one method to gather data, such as interviews, observations, questionnaires, and documents (Hussein, 2009). (Decrop, 1999). Decrop (1999) describes triangulation as derived from topography and first used in the military and navigation sciences, the concept has been fruitfully adapted to social science inquiry. This method of triangulation is based on the triangle analogy implying that a single point is considered from three different and independent sources (Decrop, 1999). Denzin (1989) cited in Kimchi et al. (1991) explains triangulation in research as an effort to make it the study clearer. Method triangulation entails the use of multiple methods to study a single problem that can be different qualitative methods or a combination of qualitative and quantitative techniques (Decrop, 1999). 'Triangulation' can be achieved by using different research technique which are helpful for cross-checking and used to provide confirmation and completeness, which brings 'balance' between two or more different types of research (Yeasmin & Rahman: 2012). According to Decrop (1999), since each method has its own boundaries and biases, and single methodologies result in personal biases, using multiple methods covers the way for more credible and dependable information. Thus, qualitative data can be used to strengthen quantitative research designs in general (Leech & Onwuegbuzie, 2007).

Triangulation means looking at the same phenomenon, or research question, from more than one source of data which the information coming from different angles can be used to corroborate, elaborate or illuminate the research problem.(Decrop, 1999). Often this purpose in specific contexts is to obtain confirmation of findings through convergence of different perspectives (Yeasmin & Rahman: 2012). 'Triangulation' for completeness purposes is used mainly in researching the less explored or unexplored research problems (Yeasmin & Rahman: 2012). This type of triangulation is very similar to the mixed method approaches used in social science research, where the results from one method are used to enhance, augment and clarify the results of another (Hales, 2010:15).

In social science research, the concept of triangulation is used metaphorically; it has various meanings and involves many corresponding procedures (Paulien et al., 2002). Hales (2010:18) implies that data and methods triangulation can reinforce the validity and credibility of a finding, which makes it much easier to explain and

justify. In addition the author explains that it can also provide a more complete and comprehensive perspective on a given situation and generate new insights into that situation). Triangulation by method is more commonly known as methodological or multi-method triangulation (Paulien et al., 2002). Paulien et al. (2002) adds that methodological triangulation is also used to refer to the combination of qualitative and quantitative data. Therefore 'triangulation' can overcome challenges related to a single-method and complement each method to better understand the subject of the study by increasing its credibility.

4. Methodology

Triangulation was performed and accomplished by the authors to clarify the understanding of film tourism regarding destination marketing of DMOs. Although the use of multiple methods in social science research is not very common, researchers preferred to combine and to complement both qualitative and quantitative methods to enhance the output of the study. Multiple methods were advocated aiming to examine the same research problem, which is the promotional activities of DMOs in terms of film tourism. Therefore this study explores film tourism marketing strategies of DMOs through triangulation.

As implied above the triangulation method was used aiming to create a more valuable output that could clarify DMOs strategies of film tourism. It's well known that organizational researchers can improve the accuracy of their judgments by collecting different kinds of data bearing on the same phenomenon (Jick, 1979). When a single research method is insufficient, triangulation is used to confirm that the most comprehensive approach is taken to solve a research problem (Morse, 1991). The deficiencies of any one method can be overcome by linking methods with triangulation and thus capitalizing on their individual strengths (Blaikie, 1991). Qualitative research is mostly preferred when there is the absence of scientific/quantitative methods in a way, which is analogous to defining darkness as the absence of light (Walle, 1997). But in this study qualitative research is done to complement the result of the quantitative analysis.

The research proceeded in three stages. In the first stage, the literature was reviewed for film tourism and related subjects in terms of destination marketing. In the second stage, online survey was developed based on Hudson and Ritchie (2006) consisting of introduction and six parts using 5 point Liker Scale. In the questionnaire there is the introduction part that describes the purpose of the study. Then in the first part, the respondents were asked to rate the importance of film tourism related marketing activities. In the second part, the respondents were asked to rate the factors that affect film tourism. Third and fourth part is about the benefits and drawbacks of film tourism brought to their destination. In the fifth part, three main open-ended questions were asked to the respondents. They were asked to comment on their degree of success in attracting film tourism; the amount of money spend for marketing film tourism at their destination and whether there were any increase in visitor numbers as a result of promoting film tourism. If they did not make an effort to develop film tourism, the respondents were asked to indicate the reason. The questionnaires were ended by a few questions about the type of the organization, the annual budget of DMO and the respondent's position in the organization. Questionnaire was sent to DMOs' contact e-mail addresses which are listed in the official website of the Destination Marketing Association International (DMAI). Most of the questionnaires were sent to the managers or officials. The others were sent to their common e-mail addresses or sent via social media addresses of DMOs. After two months the questionnaires were sent to the contact addresses once more to remind about the study. Totally 33 usable questionnaires were collected. SPSS statistical package (20, 0) was used to assess the quantitative part of the research. The total survey proceeded for 5 months.

In the third stage, qualitative research method was used to assess "film" as an attraction in destination marketing. For this purpose, the same DMO's web sites were content analyzed in terms of film tourism. Among 812 DMO web sites, 77 were under construction or could not be reached so total 735 DMO web sites were checked by authors in detail. However, content analysis is a method that the many words of the text are classified into much fewer and manageable content categories (Weber, 1990). Thus, it can be used as an effective tool to examine the content and functions of city tourism websites (Quan and Rich, 2005). In this regard, film tourism related activities are content analyzed in the qualitative part of the research.

5. Findings

5.1. Qualitative Findings

Film tourism related activities of DMO's were obtained from DMO's web sites were categorized and numbered. To reach the final list, all the film tourism related activities were counted. Those which were more than 10 were added to the list. The process resulted in the identification of 6-film tourism related categories. The categories of final list is as follows; DMO's that gives incentives or assistance to film companies, DMO's that has film protocols, film permits, movie tours, film commissions and film offices.

Table 1. Classification of Film Activities in DMOs

Category	Number of DMO
Movie Tours	10
Film Commission or Film Office	40
Film Festival	128
Film Protocol	19
Film Permit	23
Incentives or Assistance	32
TOTAL	735

- Movie Tours

Besides attracting film industry and professionals, DMOs are using popular films, which are made in their locations, to attract tourists. Hawaii Kauai island DMO is organizing movie tours for tourists as featured films like "South Pacific" and "Jurassic Park" was filmed in their destinations. Total of 10 destinations are organizing movie tours to attract tourists.

- Film Festival

As indicated in table 1, film festivals are the most popular activity that is related with film tourism and total of 128 DMO is organizing film festivals. Miami Film Mont, Chicago International Film Festival and Berkshire International Film Festival are some examples of film festivals, which are demonstrated in the DMOs web sites. There are also themed film festivals such as; PRIDE film festival which is organized in Bloomington, US every year. In this festival, gay, lesbian, bisexual and transgender issues are addressed.

- Film Commission or Film Office

Among 735 DMOs, 40 DMO has film commission or film office. The role of film commissions is to support and attract film industry to their destinations. To facilitate the film production, many film commission offices provide the services such as, local housing and discount in the hotel rates, assistance in local transportation, information and discounts for crew and cast and location, assistance in setting up film shoots and finding location. Utah Film Commission which is a member of the Association of Film Commissioners International (AFCI), gives assistance from pre-production to post-production phases and since 1920 and more than 900 films and TV movies have been filmed in the Beehive State. The Dallas Film Commission, The Irving, Texas Film Commission and Utah Film Commission are some of commissions that provide supporting services for film industry to utilize their destinations.

- Film Protocols and Film Permits

Film Commissions or film offices film permits to the film companies and are creating film protocols with them. Among 735 DMO, total 23 DMO is giving permission to film activities and total 19 DMO is making film protocols with film companies.

- Film Incentives or Film Assistance

Among 40 total of 32 film Commissions/film offices is offering incentives such as tax discounts or credits. For example, Louisiana film commission offers a 30% transferable credit for total in-state expenditures and %5 labor tax credits could be earned if they use the destination labor and resources. Likewise, Massachusetts destination is providing %25 tax incentives, 25% production credit and 25% payroll credit for filmmakers.

Besides six categories that is shown in Table 1, DMO's are organizing film related activities such as; film discussions and free film demonstration activities. Morris Museum of Art, which is located in Augusta in Georgia destination is an example of film discussions. In the museum, after screening classic films, museum director is setting a discussion about the film. Williamsburg destination is using "films" with a different concept. They provide "film taverns" in which dining and the movie experience could be done at the same time.

Destinations use popular films that are filmed in their destinations, to promote themselves. "Prison Break" and "Jaws 2" have been filmed in Pensacola and DMO is using the films as an attraction in its web site. Besides all film tourism activities some destinations position themselves as film-friendly destination. Austin is an example of a film-friendly city. Tampa Bay is another destination in US that has film friendly hotels and film friendly locations.

5.2. Quantitative Findings

The questionnaire was sent through Survey monkey and the respondents are restricted to pass the next part without answering the previous part. The first part was completed by 33 respondents, the second 28, third 23 and finally 21 respondents answered all the parts of the questionnaire. Most respondents are managers (%50), experts (%22, 7) and the others are comprising small numbers (%27, 3). More than half of them were city or town DMOs (%72,7), province and state tourism organizations (% 13,6), regional tourism organizations (RTO) (%9,1) and rural DMOs are among the smallest group (%4,5).

As presented in Table 2, packaging attractions to lengthen tourist stay (M=4.12), ensuring media coverage mentions film location (M=4.12), actively promoting the destination to film studios (M=4.03), creating links to destination on the film web site (M=4.00), providing images for media or tour operators (M=4.00), working with other organizations to promote locations the most (M=4.00), maximizing the impacts of postproduction exposure (M=3.96), assessing a film's merit in terms of its promotional value (M=3.87), offering grants and tax credits (M=3.87), and being actively involved in location scouting (M=3.81) are among the most ten important film tourism related marketing activities that is emphasized by DMOs.

Table 2. Film Tourism Related Marketing Activities

Film Tourism Related Marketing Activities	Frequency (N=33)	Mean
Package attractions to lengthen tourist stay	33	4.12
Ensure media coverage mentions film location	33	4.12
Actively promote the destination to film studios	33	4.03
Create links to destination on the film Web site	33	4
Provide images for media or tour operators	33	4
Work with other organizations to promote locations	33	4
Maximize the impacts of postproduction exposure	33	3.96
Assess a film's merit in terms of its promotional value	33	3.87
Offer grants and tax credits	33	3.87

Be actively involved in location scouting	33	3.81
Engage in joint promotions with tour operators	33	3.75
Plan activities to promote other tourism sectors	33	3.75
Negotiate end credits for the destination	33	3.72
Engage the film's stars to promote the film location	33	3.69
Promote hotels and guest houses used in films	33	3.69
Invite travel media to film location	33	3.69
Produce film and site maps for tourists	33	3.66
Post links on Web site to film tours	33	3.63
Appoint an executive or PR specialist	33	3.60
Engage in promotional activity with film companies	33	3.60
Attract media attention at each release window	33	3.60
Invite travel media to special release of the film	33	3.59
Have guided tours and/or film walks	33	3.57
Develop a dedicated Web site for potential tourists	33	3.54
Replicate or maintain film icons/sites/scenes/sets	33	3.51
Host events that continue the pull of the film	33	3.39
Post signage and interpretation at the location	33	3.39
Create exhibits or displays of film memorabilia	33	3.36
Produce a "making of the film" feature	33	3.15
Sell film memorabilia	33	2.84
Sponsor the film directly	33	2.72

As indicated in Table 3, destination's scenery (M=4.53), an image tourists want to explore or discover (M=4.35), identifiable and accessible locations (M=4.32), destination's backdrop (M=4.25), the success of the film (M=4.21), cost (M=4.21), destination awareness (M=4.17), expertise (M=4.10), resources (M=4.10) and a film location that has an emotional (M=4.10) are among the most ten important factors that affect film tourism.

Table 3. Factors That Affect Film Tourism

Factors That Affect Film Tourism	Frequency (N=28)	Mean
Destination's Scenery	28	4.53
An image tourists want to explore or discover	28	4.35
Identifiable and accessible locations	28	4.32
Destination's Backdrop	28	4.25
The success of the film	28	4.21
Cost	28	4.21
Destination Awareness	28	4.17
Expertise	28	4.10
Resources	28	4.10
A film location that has an emotional attachment	28	4.10
Destination Icons	28	4.10
Labor	28	4.03
Amount of exposure/ length of time on the screen	28	4
Destination Brand	28	4

Active promotion	28	4
A location that has a physical icon that viewers can identify with	28	4
Scouting services	28	3.96
Taxes	28	3.85
Untainted environments	28	3.82
Destination's Sets	28	3.78
Tax breaks	28	3.75
Dedicated Web sites	28	3.71
Relevance of the story to the location /clear link	28	3.71
Lobbying	28	3.50

The respondents indicated that film tourism brought positive economic impacts to their destinations (M=4.17). Broadening the base of the visitor market (M=4.04), bringing higher tourist visitation (M=3.95), increasing in visitor numbers (M=3.95), creating stronger destination image or destination brand (M=3.82) are the first five important benefits of film tourism that is indicated by the respondents.

Table 4. Benefits of Film Tourism

Benefits of Film Tourism	Frequency (N=23)	Mean
Positive economic impacts	23	4.17
Broadening the base of the visitor market	23	4.04
Higher tourist visitation	23	3.95
Increasing in visitor numbers	23	3.95
Stronger destination image or destination brand	23	3.82
The effects of film tourism is enduring	23	3.78
Preservation of sites and locations	23	3.65
Improvements to infrastructure	23	3.65
Reducing problems of seasonality	23	3.34

Besides the benefits of film tourism, dissatisfaction of visitors due to the different appeal of location than how it is portrayed in the film (M=3.04) is emphasized as the most important drawback of film tourism by the respondents. As can be seen in Table 5, increased traffic and crowding (M=2.76), negative environmental impacts (M=2.71) and increase in prices due to the influx of production crews are the other indicated drawbacks of film tourism.

Table 5. Drawbacks of film tourism

Drawbacks of film tourism	Frequency (N=21)	Mean
Dissatisfaction of visitors due to the different appeal of location than how it is portrayed in the film	21	3.04
Increased traffic and crowding	21	2.76
Negative environmental impacts	21	2.71
Increase in prices due to the influx of production crews	21	2.71

In the final part of the questionnaire, the respondents were asked to comment on their degree of their success in attracting film tourism, how much do they spend on marketing efforts that is listed in the section1, whether if they have seen an increase in visitor numbers as a result of their efforts in promoting film tourism. They were asked to indicate the reason, if they have had not make an effort to develop film tourism. Annual budget of their DMO was the final question of the questionnaire. Among 19 DMOs 9 of them has the annual budget below \$2 million, 5

DMOs between \$ 2 million and \$ 5 million, 2 of them has more than \$ 5 million and one of the DMOs annual budget is unspecified.

There were 15 answers for the question, which the respondents are asked for the comments on their degree of success in attracting film tourism. Among 15 comments most of the DMOs evaluated themselves successful in attracting film tourism. One of the respondents indicated that Old Tucson studios was the second most visited attraction in Arizona after the Grand Canyon for decades and commended that this is the success of film tourism. The other respondent commended that they had been successful due to state's (State of Virginia) leadership in their area, and due to their authentic architecture landscape and historic setting they reached success. A DMO representative stated that they have had a relative good success on the other hand the other DMO indicated that they had films made at their destination that feature enough to be recognizable but the places the filming took place were not open to public. Some of the respondents stated that film tourism is only a small segment for them. The others commended that they are trying to develop strategy for film tourism. Small group of the respondents among 15 DMOs stated that they don't actively seek film tourism as they are suburban metro area or film tourism has not been a priority for their DMO.

Secondly the respondents are asked to write the amount of money their DMO spend to the on film tourism related marketing efforts, which are listed in the Table1. Among 15 respondents one DMOs representative stated that as they are a small city of less than 300.000, they do not have a major budget- but they do have resources to provide and collaborate with the city on attracting and servicing the film industry. Two of the respondents indicated that there was a dedicated agency installed to attract filmmakers and they were co-marketed film tourism with their Film Office. The other DMO stated that they spend \$ 5,000 annually. One of them indicated that the amount of money they spend varies. 5 of DMO representative stated that they have no budget allocated for film tourism related marketing efforts. Thirdly the respondents are asked whether they have seen an increase in visitor numbers as a result of their efforts in promoting film tourism. One of the respondents gave an example of Old Tucson, which has been in business since 1935. The other DMO had a relative increase visitor numbers. Most of the DMOs stated that they have not tracked the increase in visitor numbers. Finally, DMOs were asked to indicate the reason, if they did not make an effort to develop film tourism. In terms of lack of resources and funding, film tourism can be regarded as a very niche market was the most common replies for this question. One respondent stated that they haven't got suitable product ie. where Harry Potter was filmed. They have some buildings and scenery that has played a minor role in some well-known films, but not enough to "make a day of fit".

6. Conclusion

This study explores the use of triangulation in film tourism marketing strategies of DMOs. Therefore the research involved a three-fold process to get a deeper understanding of DMOs' point of view and applications about film tourism. In fact, many heritage sites that serve as film locations gain popularity after the film release because these places acquire specific meaning through film narration. Film can enhance the destination image and increase the awareness of the host city. The success of film locations rely on the success of films. Film tourism is a specific pattern of tourism that drives visitors to see screen places during or after production of a feature film or a television production now tourist boards and tourist offices are promoting film location holidays, film destination holidays, movie walks and movie tours. The development of film-induced tourism was made through the media. Through its image creating potential, film can also provide strong motivation to tourists to actually visit the places they have seen on the screen Destination and or location placement in movies and TV shows is an attractive and beneficial marketing tool. Films can influence the travelling preferences of individuals. They can ensure essential information on a destination, in short time and to many persons. Finally, as Vagionis & Loumiot (2011) imply an important factor is always the budget that is committed to this aim

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